

What is Scratch?

Scratch is a visual programming language that makes coding simple. It can be used to make all sorts of fun and interesting programs.

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Colored blocks **30–31** › and scripts

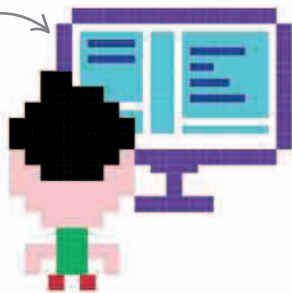
Understanding Scratch

Scratch is perfect for making games and animations. It has large collections (or “libraries”) of cool graphics and sounds that you can play around with.

1 Start programming

Scratch is a programming language. There's not much typing, and it's easy to get started.

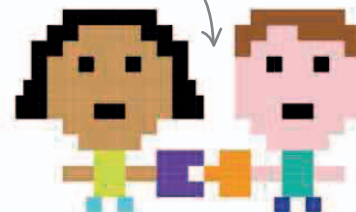
Write your first program in Scratch!



2 Put together programming blocks

Scratch uses colored blocks of code. Blocks are selected and joined together to make a script, which is a set of instructions.

Blocks lock together like jigsaw pieces



3 Make sprites move and speak

Objects such as people, vehicles, and animals can be added to a program. These objects are called sprites. Scripts make them move and speak.

Sprites can be programmed to walk, run, and dance



Sprites like me can be programmed to talk in speech bubbles.



LINGO

Why is it called Scratch?

“Scratching” is a way of mixing different sounds to make new music. The Scratch programming language enables you to mix pictures, sounds, and scripts to make new computer programs.

